At March 31, 2019, the U.S. consolidated group of companies had the following tax credit carryforwards available (amounts in thousands):

	Tax Credits ($)	Fiscal Year of Expiration
U.S. research credits	$ 1,253	2024
Texas franchise tax credits	2,141	2026

The Company conducts business in Macedonia and Thailand through subsidiaries that qualify for a tax holiday. The tax holiday for Macedonia will terminate on January 1, 2023. For calendar years 2017, 2018, and 2019, the statutory rate of 10% was reduced to zero. The tax holiday for Thailand will terminate on June 15, 2020. For the 2019 fiscal year, the statutory rate of 20% was reduced to zero. For the fiscal year ended March 31, 2019 the Company realized no income tax benefit from the tax holidays.

Prior to the Tax Cuts and Jobs Act of 2017, earnings of a foreign subsidiary were taxed when remitted to the U.S. With the Tax Cuts and Jobs Act of 2017, the Company is permitted a 100% exemption from U.S. tax on foreign earnings remitted to the U.S. and the U.S group recognizes no deferred tax liability at March 31, 2019 relating to unremitted foreign earnings. The Company asserts that no foreign earnings subject to a withholding tax will be remitted to the U.S.

At March 31, 2019, the Company had $7.7 million of unrecognized tax benefits. A reconciliation of gross unrecognized tax benefits (excluding interest and penalties) is as follows (amounts in thousands):

	Fiscal Years Ended March 31,		
	2019	2018	2017
Beginning of fiscal year	$ 8,680	$ 7,390	$ 7,103
Additions from business combinations	—	1,270	—
Additions for tax positions of the current year	2,027	1,078	762
Additions for tax positions of prior years	519	—	—
Reductions for tax positions of prior years	(633)	(1,058)	(64)
Lapse in statute of limitations	(9)	—	(411)
Settlements	(2,923)	—	—
End of fiscal year	$ 7,661	$ 8,680	$ 7,390

At March 31, 2019, $1.9 million of the $7.7 million of unrecognized income tax benefits would affect the Company's effective income tax rate, if recognized. It is reasonably possible that the total unrecognized tax benefit could decrease by $1.0 million in fiscal year 2020 if the advanced pricing arrangement for one of the Company's foreign subsidiaries is agreed to by the foreign tax authority and an ongoing audit in one of the Company's foreign jurisdictions is settled.

The Company files income tax returns in the U.S. and multiple foreign jurisdictions, including various state and local jurisdictions. The U.S. Internal Revenue Service concluded its examinations of the Company's U.S. federal tax returns for all tax years through 2003. Because of net operating losses, the Company's U.S. federal returns for 2003 and later years will remain subject to examination until the losses are utilized. The Company is subject to income tax examinations in various foreign and U.S. state jurisdictions for the years 2014 and forward. The Company records potential interest and penalty expenses related to unrecognized income tax benefits within its global operations in income tax expense. The Company had $0.5 million and $0.9 million of accrued interest and penalties respectively at March 31, 2019 and 2018, which are included as a component of income tax expense. To the extent interest and penalties are not assessed with respect to uncertain tax positions, amounts accrued will be reduced and reflected as a reduction of the overall income tax provision.